

With google maps, it is possible to search any place, distances between places etc with just a click on mouse. Then there are websites such as Quora and Yahoo Answers where content is structured in the form of questions. Add to it intelligent tagging and these websites make it super easy for answers to your questions.

So if there's anything you can't search, it is most likely something that is still not digitized, still not available on web.

Semantic search: solving big data problems

With tons of information on web, it is becoming tedious for companies to deal with this overwhelming volumes of data. Though big data solutions such as Hadoop are working their way around this problem of plenty, searching this huge volumes of data for relevant results is what major search engines are struggling with. This is where Semantic Search comes in. It's about associating meaning to the search terms and queries. With semantic search, the search engine aims to be aware of context of your search query and thus understand what you actually want to search. It improves the accuracy and significance of the search results by understanding the contextual meaning of you query.

Semantic search is not about simply matching strings. The idea is to consider synonyms, common spell errors, variation in languages, same words with multiple meanings, locational information and domain. The search engine attempts to

understand what you truly intend to search. For example is you're planning your vacation, you just enter your family's preferences and you are given matching travel destinations automatically. In May 2012, Google came up with Knowledge Graph that links context to your searches using the idea of "things and not strings". Knowledge graph relies on information from credible sources such as Wikipedia and gives you a set of card results for your search query. These cards are connected with each others based on relationships. Based on this technology Google Play showcased face recognition to digup you an information card about the actors in the movie you are watching it. When it comes to search terms, language can be ambiguous. If you search for Lincoln, you may be searching for the movie, the president or even an old beat up car. Google's knowledge graph (if it works in the intended way) tries to show you a card with disambiguated information. Knowledge graph connects the huge volume of data on web based on relationships and relevance. Recently in March 2013, Facebook announced Graph Search feature which is a step ahead in semantic search. It takes into consideration the personal relationships, likes, dislikes and preferences and searches the results within the information available to your Facebook network. Also, it lets you search using natural language queries rather than keywords. The search is powered by the data that Facebook has accumulated since its launch including pages, public

posts, check-ins, places, events etc. and is personalised for you. With Graph search "My friends who work at Zynga" and "My friends who used to work at Zynga" will lead to different set of results as it is based on context and understands your query well. The time may not be far when you can just ask a search engine for which tablet you should buy and it will give you results based on tablets that your friends own, their reviews, tablets popular in your area etc.

Social Search: Digitizing people

With social search, the results to your search queries will depend upon the content accessible to the search engine about your circle on social networks such as Google+. Facebook etc. Your search about "Which is the best restaurant in Mumbai" will result into options keeping in mind the restaurants your friends have been to on Facebook and Four-square check-ins, restaurants you have been to in the past, restaurants that are geographically near you, restaurants that are rated high on social networks and other such contextual attributes.

Search Engines such as Bing and Google have already started to show you popular search results based on the fact that your friends or friends of friends like those results. Thus, social graphs and social search can lead to subjective queries with more personal results. This also has tremendous power of marketing and advertising as adver-



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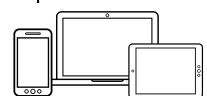


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